higher education & training

Department:
Higher Education and Training
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

NATIONAL CERTIFICATE (VOCATIONAL)

BUSINESS PRACTICE
NQF LEVEL 4

(3061004)

18 November 2019 (X-Paper)
09:00–12:00

This question paper consists of 13 pages.

Copyright reserved

TIME: 3 HOURS
MARKS: 200

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. Answer ALL the questions.
2. Read ALL the questions carefully.
3. Number the answers according to the numbering system used in this question paper.
4. Start each section on a NEW page.
5. Use only blue or black ink.
6. Write neatly and legibly.

Copyright reserved

SECTION A

QUESTION 1

1.1 Various options are given as possible answers to the following questions. Choose the correct answer and write only the letter (A–D) next to the question number (1.1.1–1.1.15) in the ANSWER BOOK.

1.1.1 An example of a good practice is to delegate only …

A to persons skilled enough to do the task.
B all those tasks you do not want to do.
C to persons who do not need supervision.
D easy tasks.

1.1.2 An important principle on which the code of conduct should be based:

A Punctuality
B Determination
C Procrastination
D Honesty

1.1.3 A/An … is an example of nonverbal communication:

A SMS
B fax
C emoji
D e-mail

1.1.4 An example of an external force which could affect time utilisation:

A Answering the telephone
B Procrastination
C Not saying no
D Lack of planning

1.1.5 The entry of new competitors has an impact on the … of the business.

A microenvironment
B market environment
C macroenvironment
D internal environment

1.1.6 An example of industrial action:

A Disciplinary hearing
B Go-slow
C Suspension
D Demotion

Copyright reserved

1.1.7 An impact of HIV/AIDS on a business:

A Higher worker absenteeism
B Higher worker productivity
C Higher profitability
D Higher revenue

1.1.8 Guideline for confidentiality and data protection within a business environment:

A Having all confidential conversations at one's desk.
B Discussing all personal staff matters outside the workplace.
C Keeping all confidential information locked away when not in use.
D Binning all confidential information immediately.

1.1.9 An effect withholding labour can have on a business:

A Increase in stock shortages
B Increase in wage costs
C Increase in profits
D Increase in productivity

1.1.10 A way of providing positive feedback in the workplace:

A Criticise the person and not the action.
B Overlook unimportant things.
C Concentrate on correcting the person.
D Ignore the incorrect action.

1.1.11 One of the following is NOT a good planning tool:

A Recording all appointments
B Regularly updating the diary
C Recording of selected appointments only
D Consulting the diary regularly

1.1.12 The role of trade unions is NOT to …

A negotiate for better wages and working conditions.
B protect workers from unfair dismissals.
C represent workers in all personal legal matters.
D educate workers on their rights in the workplace.

1.1.13 Working together on a particular task or project is called team …

A work.
B dynamics.
C coherence.
D spirit.

Copyright reserved

1.1.14 Examples of internal stakeholders:

A Employees
B Customers
C Competitors
D Suppliers

1.1.15 Aspect of culture:

A Qualifications
B Social status
C Education
D Remuneration

(15 × 1) (15)

1.2 Indicate whether the following statements are TRUE or FALSE. Write only 'True' or 'False' next to the question number (1.2.1–1.2.10) in the ANSWER BOOK. Correct the statement if it is FALSE.

1.2.1 Planning outgoing calls will have a positive influence on productivity.

1.2.2 HIV/AIDS has little or no impact on the business sector.

1.2.3 The repo rate has an impact on interest charged on debt.

1.2.4 Cultural differences in the workplace may lead to conflict.

1.2.5 Team dynamics is the only force that impacts on the success of a team.

1.2.6 Listening is the most important skill in the communication process.

1.2.7 Decreasing the unemployment rate is the sole responsibility of government.

1.2.8 Businesses have no legal obligation to look after the environment.

1.2.9 To be effective a business plan must include deadlines.

1.2.10 COSATU is the biggest trade union in South Africa.

(15)

Copyright reserved

1.3 Choose a description from COLUMN B that matches a term in COLUMN A. Write only the letter (A–K) next to the question number (1.3.1–1.3.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

COLUMN A		COLUMN B	
1.3.1	Trade unions	A	recording of all tasks and person responsible for each task
1.3.2	Delegation	B	tasks which may not be urgent but must be done
1.3.3	Deadline	C	setting time by which task must be completed
1.3.4	Work schedule	D	transferring of information by using ways other than words
1.3.5	Price discrimination	E	assigning some of your tasks to someone else
1.3.6	Collective bargaining	F	working together to achieve the same goals
1.3.7	Nonverbal communication	G	way in which teams work together and react to one another
1.3.8	Team dynamics	H	negotiations between trade unions, employer and employees
1.3.9	Industrial action	I	organisations acting on behalf of workers
1.3.10	Routine tasks	J	protest actions by workers against employers
		K	charging different prices for the same product

(10 × 1) (10)
[40]

TOTAL SECTION A: 40

SECTION B

QUESTION 2

2.1 Read the extract below and answer the questions.

POORER SOUTH AFRICANS ZERO RATE GIGABA FOR VAT HIKES

MINISTER'S REVENUE DEMANDS HIT LOW EARNERS IN POCKETS

By: Pericles Anetos and Farren Collins

From walking to work to growing their own vegetables South Africans are looking for ways to stretch their rands in anticipation of VAT and levy increases on 1 April 2018.

Dennis Gumede, a bricklayer from Magaliesburg and a father of three, says: 'Everything goes up but we have nothing. There is no way for me even to save money.'

Domestic worker Mpolo Mmakolobe was concerned about the cost of commuting. 'The higher fuel levies are going to affect my pocket badly because taxi owners are going to increase their prices,' she said.

Finance Minister Malusi Gigaba said in his budget on Wednesday that the zero-rating of basic foods such as maize meal, brown bread, dried beans, rice, lentils, eggs, milk, fruit and vegetables would 'limit the impact on the poorest households'.

Hoodah Abrahams-Fayker, the national advocacy manager for Black Sash, said the poor would have to take out loans to keep up with tax increases. 'This will leave them in a vicious cycle of debt where they will have to incur debt to pay basic living expenses.'

[Adapted from: *Sunday Times* 25/02/2018]

2.1.1 Write down the acronym VAT in full. (1)

2.1.2 To what rate was VAT increased on 1 April 2018? (2)

2.1.3 Explain the possible impact of this increase in VAT on each of the following:

(a) Individuals (2 × 2) (4)

(b) Businesses (2 × 2) (4)

2.1.4 What is meant by *zero rating of basic foods*? (1)

2.1.5 Briefly describe how the zero rating of basic foods should limit the impact of VAT on the poorest households. (2)

2.1.6 The fuel levy was also increased on 1 April 2018.

State ONE possible impact of the increase in fuel levy on each of the following:

(a) Individuals (1 × 2) (2)

(b) Businesses (1 × 2) (2)

2.2 'Communication, whether it is done in writing, verbally or electronically, plays a very important role in any business.' Certain communication barriers can obstruct the communication process.'

With regard to this statement answer the following questions:

2.2.1 Define the THREE types of communications and provide ONE example of each. Present your answer in the following table format:

Type of communication	Definition	Example
Written		
Verbal		
Electronic		

(3 × 3) (9)

2.2.2 Choose ONE of the communication barriers in the table below that matches the following examples. Write the answer next to the question number in the ANSWER BOOK.

semantic; psychological; physical; physiological

(a) Background noise

(b) Poor hearing

(c) Not being able to understand the language

(3 × 1) (3)

[30]

QUESTION 3

3.1 What is meant by a *code of conduct*? (2)

3.2 State ONE reason for the implementation of a code of conduct in the workplace. (2)

3.3 Briefly discuss any TWO implications a code of conduct could have on the employees of an organisation. (2 × 2) (4)

3.4 Compile a code of conduct setting out ONE guideline for the relationship between the organisation and the following:

3.4.1 Customers (2)

3.4.2 Competitors (2)

3.5 Discuss any FOUR remedial actions against those who deviate from the code of conduct. (4 × 2) (8)

3.6 Specify whether the following actions are ETHICAL or UNETHICAL. Write only 'Ethical' or 'Unethical' next to the question number (3.6.1–3.6.5) in the ANSWER BOOK.

3.6.1 Taking a stapler home for your daughter's school project

3.6.2 Using the office internet to search a venue for a training workshop for new employees

3.6.3 Using the company credit card to pay for lunch during your business trip

3.6.4 Making a dentist's appointment for your manager's wife during office hours

3.6.5 Taking a month's leave without prior consultation with your manager

(5 × 1) (5)
[25]

QUESTION 4

'If you reject the food, ignore the customs and traditions, fear the religion and avoid the people, you might better stay home.' – James A Michener



4.1 In the quote above James A Michener addresses people travelling to foreign countries.

4.1.1 Do you think that this is good advice to give to such visitors? (1)

4.1.2 Give ONE reason for your answer in QUESTION 4.1.1. (2)

4.2 In his advice he refers to different aspects of the culture of a country.

What is meant by *culture*? (2)

4.3 Name ONE other aspect of culture NOT mentioned in his advice to foreign visitors. (1)

4.4 List FIVE needs tourists may have when visiting another country. (5)

4.5 Give THREE reasons why it is important to anticipate and deal with the needs of foreign visitors. (3 × 2) (6)

4.6 Explain how misunderstandings between foreign visitors and local staff can be resolved. (4 × 2) (8)

[25]

QUESTION 5

Study the cartoon and answer the questions.



[Source: *www.keyword-suggestions.com*]

5.1 What is meant by a timewaster in the workplace? (1)

5.2 5.2.1 Does the cartoon depict an example of a timewaster? (1)

5.2.2 Give a reason for your answer in QUESTION 5.2.1. (1)

5.3 Briefly explain how each of the following could become timewasters in a business environment:

5.3.1 Telephone calls (2)

5.3.2 Paperwork (2)

5.3.3 Running errands (2)

Copyright reserved

5.4 Give ONE way in which each of the following timewasters could be eliminated or minimised in a business environment:

5.4.1 Telephone calls (2)

5.4.2 Paperwork (2)

5.4.3 Running errands (2)

5.5 Briefly discuss how prioritisation could help in eliminating and managing timewasters. (2 × 2) (4)

5.6 What is meant by a work plan in a business organisation? (4 × 1) (4)

5.7 Why is it important to know and understand the goals and objectives of an organisation when drawing up a work plan? (2)

[25]

QUESTION 6

6.1 Briefly explain the difference between:

6.1.1 Team spirit (2)

6.1.2 Team coherence (2)

6.2 Briefly explain FOUR ways in which a manager can build team spirit and coherence. (4 × 2) (8)

6.3 'Show respect even to people who don't deserve it, not as a reflection of their character, but as a reflection of yours.' – Dave Willis

6.3.1 Explain the meaning of the above statement. (2)

6.3.2 Do you agree with his statement? (1)

6.3.3 Give ONE reason for your answer in QUESTION 6.3.2. (2)

6.3.4 Describe FOUR ways in which to show respect for a team member. (4 × 2) (8)

[25]

QUESTION 7

7.1 Read the extract and answer the questions.

BRICKIES TO WELDERS, APPIES WILL BE BACK



South Africa's 50 technical vocational education and training colleges could soon specialise in teaching certain trades if Naledi Pandor has her way. Pandor, who replaced Hlengiwe Mkhize as Minister of Higher Education and Training in February 2018, is committed to college specialisation.

In an interview with the Sunday Times, Pandor said her department was piloting the college-of-specialisation model next year at 26 institutions. A total of 790 students will be selected as the pilot group to be trained in one of 13 priority trades, which include electrical work, plumbing, welding, carpentry, bricklaying and boiler making.

'The TVET colleges are going to be a particular focus for me because I really believe they hold great promise for the future of the youth in our country. I don't want just to train young people for the sake of a certificate. I'd like them to be absorbed in the workplace, in industry or in creating their own businesses.

'We need competent bricklayers; we need plumbers because young people must be able to start their own enterprises. If government wants to rescue the country's economy, they need technical people.'

[Adapted from: *Sunday Times,* 29 April 2018]

7.1.1 What was Naledi Pandor's position in government at the time of this article? (1)

7.1.2 'It is clear that Minister Pandor wants to prevent students from being unemployed.' Explain *unemployment*. (2)

7.1.3 Briefly discuss any FOUR reasons for unemployment in South Africa. (4 × 2) (8)

7.1.4 Name THREE areas on which the minister wants to focus. (3)

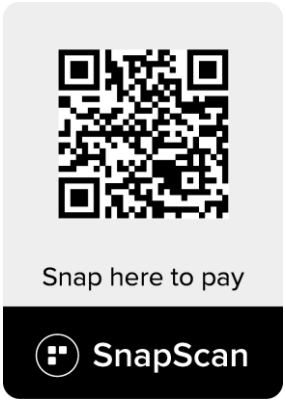
Copyright reserved

7.1.5 'The minister also focuses on sustainable development and employment.'

Motivate this statement by wiring down any FOUR reasons why the minister is committed to College Specialisation. (4 × 2) (8)

7.2 Read the extract and answer the questions.

PROUDLY SOUTH AFRICAN APPS



Snapscan

Have you ever wanted to pay for something and then realised you do not have enough cash with you?
Like most of us I'm sure you worry a lot about your card being cloned and having to deal with borrowing money from friends and family to see you through the month.
Well, worry no more. Snapscan is here for you and it is locally made.

The app allows you to:
Make quick and convenient payments using your phone
Buy at shops and markets without handing over your card
Pay with your debit or credit card (no extra wallet)
See a list of previous transactions
Locate great merchants close to you (across South Africa)

[Adapted from: *New Age* 23/08/2016]

7.2.1 State TWO advantages of using Snapscan to pay for your purchases. (2 × 2) (4)

7.2.2 State TWO advantages for a business if customers use Snapscan to make payments. (2 × 2) (4)
[30]

TOTAL SECTION B: 160
GRAND TOTAL: 200

Copyright reserved